John Leighow

Senior Data Engineer & Power BI Business Intelligence Analyst

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@John updated Oct 19, 2026

Professional Summary

Senior Data Engineer and Power BI Business Intelligence Analyst with extensive experience developing interactive dashboards and scalable data pipelines. Expertise includes advanced DAX and Power Query transformations, building pipelines with Azure Data Factory and SQL Server, and engineering Power BI row-level security with CRM-integrated drill-through reporting. I don't just build the data infrastructure — I own the architecture decisions and present the reasoning behind them to leadership. Built the data engineering and architecture plan for The Health Institute's move off a legacy GHL/Make/Airtable pipeline toward a more robust Snowflake-based architecture, part of the team planning its shift from a CRM (GHL) to an EHR (Healthie); also built HIPAA-compliant AI workflows. Proven ability to partner with business leaders, translate requirements into operational reporting, and apply statistical analysis to optimize campaign performance.

Skills

- **Data & Analytics:** Power BI, Power BI Row-Level Security, Microsoft SQL, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB, Google BigQuery, Azure Data Factory, Fabric Data Factory, Informatica.
- **Software & Systems:** CCaaS, Salesforce CRM, Coupler.io, Microsoft Windows OS, Mac OS, EHR, EMR, DevOps, Azure, Airtable, Microsoft Access, Microsoft Excel, Microsoft Word, Microsoft PowerPoint, Jira, Azure DevOps, Blockchain.
- **IT & Infrastructure:** CCaaS Reporting, CCaaS Management, Windows (legacy–11), macOS (Classic–Sequoia), Linux, Hardware Diagnostics, Network Troubleshooting, Remote Support Tooling. A passion for compatibility — built to work across every OS, for every user.

- **AI & Programming:** Visual Basic.NET, DAX, M, Python, R, PHP, HTML, Microsoft Copilot, Gemini, Claude, ChatGPT.
- **Soft Skills:** Agile Methodology, Project Management, UAT / User Acceptance Testing, Real Time Operations, HIPAA Compliance, Data Governance, Email Marketing, Business Analysis, Startup Capable.

Work Experience

The Health Institute — Data and Insights Analyst (Acting Senior Data Analyst / Data Engineer) | Jan 2026 – Oct 2026

- **Data Engineering & Architecture:** Part of the team planning The Health Institute's shift from a CRM (GHL) to an EHR (Healthie); owned the data engineering and architecture plan — moving off a legacy GHL → Make → Airtable pipeline toward a Snowflake-based architecture with GHL and Healthie as governed sources. The EHR launched successfully before I left — I owned UAT for that launch, defining test cases and validating the edge cases that actually break things, not just the happy path — while the Snowflake cutover was still in progress. Set up a faster data flow and opened the door for AI-automated reporting.
- **Pipeline Optimization & Automation:** Built Coupler.io pipelines (Power Query M, DAX) and Airtable automations that self-clean duplicates and cut downtime — letting several team members stop manually pulling data daily, even on vacation.
- **Marketing & Sales Analytics:** Replaced manually-captured ad-spend modeling (ROAS, click-to-impression across GHL funnels) with a true daily view, directly driving budget reallocation away from underperforming channels.
- **Executive Reporting & BI:** Built storytelling Power BI dashboards from cleansed, EST/UTC-harmonized data, with row-level security (reps see only their own data) and CRM-integrated drill-through links — replacing a column-by-column spreadsheet with a one-glance daily executive snapshot (sanitized mockup at johnleighow.com).
- **Secure AI Integration:** Strengthened the company's HIPAA compliance posture (not a priority before I joined) by engineering AI workflows (Python, Claude, Gemini, Grok) that kept identifiable data out of reporting and anything external, with KPI columns precisely scoped for accurate analysis.
- **Data Governance & Compliance:** Built multi-join flows so internal and de-identified external reporting run off the same source.

Ontrak Health — Data Engineer / Lead Data Analyst / Data Manager | Jan 2020 – Jul 2025

- Owned ingestion automation (Azure Data Factory, Microsoft Fabric) — built normalization logic adapting each health plan's unique claims-file format to our standard EDI format.
- **Project Management:** Led monthly data-feed processing and EHR ingestion projects, with several employees reporting to me for each cycle.
- **Health Plan Offboarding:** Owned data cleanup whenever a health plan's contract ended or they requested removal — wrote the steps, rules, and processes, and ran it as a formal project three times over two years with 9 departments reporting to me, assigning and tracking work end-to-end through Jira and later Azure DevOps.
- Built advanced Power BI reporting and ran research queries across PostgreSQL, Microsoft SQL/T-SQL, and Google BigQuery.
- Built data quality checks for health-plan data using R, Power BI, SQL views, and stored procedures.
- Hands-on across Ontrak's CRM-to-EHR shift — form design, reporting rebuild, and storage architecture, including FHIR-formatted ingestion into MongoDB.
- Delivered executive outreach reporting for shareholder calls; applied machine learning to refine eligibility requirements.
- Engineered Gemini prompts for concise health-coach call summaries; optimized databases across Azure, Google Cloud, and AWS.

Best Buy — Geek Squad — Services Data Analyst / Remote Support / Technical Support Lead | Aug 2006 – Jan 2020

- Managed real-time staffing and operations for a distributed remote workforce, 24/7/365.
- Delivered insights using Power BI and Microsoft Dynamics Reports that led to operational changes; used statistical inference to build hypotheses from daily data.
- Diagnosed Microsoft CRM issues and developed alerting functions to minimize downtime; built reporting to monitor real-time support traffic.
- Repaired hardware and resolved OS-level issues in-home and in-store across Windows, macOS, and Linux — spanning legacy releases through current.
- Achieved top customer satisfaction company-wide, 2010–2012; simplified technical information for non-technical clients.

Freelance & Personal Projects

Consultant & Fraud Incident Manager — DYOR Project | Nov 2021 – Present

- Provide deep insight and analysis into scam coins/tokens in cryptocurrency and track down bad actors.
- Support the CEO in planning infrastructure for eventual growth into an educational platform.
- Built and support site integrations for Telegram, Discord, and real-time cryptocurrency data.

Web Archivist & Server Developer — BigRedH, HLWiki, Macintosh Garden, Battle.net Docs, MogHouse.cc | 2004 – Present

- Rebuild historical archives using AI, Python, PHP, and MySQL.
- Host game servers for old Mac OS games and document Hotline software.
- Recreate FFXI in C++, experimenting with databases and scripting.

Education

Associates, Specialized Business – Information Systems Erie Business Center, New Castle, PA | Aug 2006